

Rep. Tom Emmer on Varney and Co.

Fox Business Network

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STUART VARNEY:

House Majority Whip Tom Emmer is here with me to discuss that. I think you've got a problem, \$4 gas, \$6 diesel, 7% mortgages. It's hard to argue that you're better than them when it comes to the economy.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, we do have a lot to sell. I understand where Senator Kennedy's coming from on the Senate side, and you'll notice that Chad was just interviewing Senators. If you talk to Republicans on the House side, Stuart, we have accomplished a ton. No taxes on overtime, no taxes on TIP. We raised the child care tax credit. The list goes on and on. You can buy an American-made car, and you can deduct your interest on that loan. There are so many things to work on that the House actually has accomplished. You've got to just go back to it, because yes, there are headwinds that are created by \$6 diesel, \$4 gas, groceries. These are headwinds that you've got to deal with, but the beauty of the U.S. House of Representatives, which people are missing, is we are not just a monolith. We are 435 pieces of geography. Each one has unique demographics to that geography.

STUART VARNEY:

And you're elected or re-elected every two years.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, and here's the thing. We don't set the national message. I've got news for people watching. 1994 is never coming back with the communication we have now, but the national message can weight down on our candidates. But if you have a great incumbent who understands his or her district, who knows who they're talking to and who they're trying to identify and motivate to vote, you can fight through that national message.

STUART VARNEY:

Politics is in your blood, isn't it?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I like to win. Well, you run to win, but Stuart, you win to govern.

STUART VARNEY:

Rahm Emanuel believes that Democrats can win back the Midwest, including your state. What's your answer to that?

REP. TOM EMMER:

No, no. Recent polling showed progressive candidate Peggy Flanagan's Senate lead collapsing against Michelle Tafoya.

STUART VARNEY:

You think Tafoya's going to win, for sure?

REP. TOM EMMER:

First off, I wish we would start calling them what they really are, progressive, Democratic, socialist nonsense. These are communists and Marxists. That's who they are. Peggy Flanagan is an absolute radical left wing nutbag from Minneapolis who has been at Tim Wall's side for the last four years as the fraud just became so bad that he couldn't run again. Rahm Emanuel? Look, you're the same guy who thought that Tim Wall's jazz hands was going to go around this country and somehow get people excited for nothing. It was all hot air. And Tim Wall is one of the most incompetent people on the face of the planet that Rahm Emanuel was telling me was going to win. So no, I don't agree. I think Republicans, Minnesotans are smarter than Rahm Emanuel is going to give them credit for. They understand that we started from an awful place after four years of Joe Biden, double digit inflation that we hadn't seen in 40 years. You couldn't make ends meet. Guess what? Inflation is now in just 18 months come down to just over 3 percent. It's still moving. We had a jobs report last week that was three times what they expected. And by the way, it wasn't just gig economy jobs. It wasn't DoorDash and Uber, which aren't bad. These were high paying, high tech and manufacturing jobs that provide benefits. There's great news in the economy. And I'll just leave one other because this is your area. If you don't think your country's headed in the right direction, don't consumers tighten their belt? In this case, consumers spending is up six percent from last year. I think people are going to do that emotional thing like somebody just sent me a meme that said four dollar gas and six dollar diesel. Not acceptable, but it's not going to get me to vote for a communist. This thing was in the town.

STUART VARNEY:

That was good. Majority of work. Tom Emmer. What a pleasure. Come and see us again anytime you like.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Love to. Thanks.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

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